

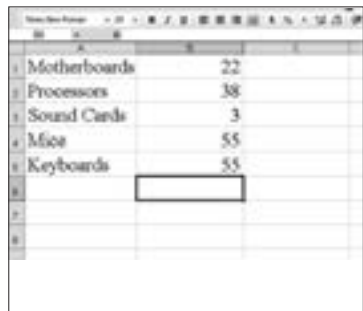
To do this, you enter a formula into cell B6. All formulas begin with an equals sign, so type an '=' and then enter the formula. In this case, we want to add the contents in cells B2, B3, B4, and B5, so you type '=B2+B3+B4+B5' into cell B6. You can enter the formula directly into the cell, or type it into the formula bar. You do not need to use capital letters; Excel will convert them to capitals if you don't use them.

When you press [Enter] or click another cell to go on to another task, the sum of the values in cells B2 through B5 will appear in B6. If you change one or more of the values in cells B2 through B5, the total in B6 will be instantly recalculated.

If you want 'total' just to be the sum of the values in cells B2 and B4, your formula would be '=B2+B4.'

You can calculate the values from any selection of cells; they do not have to be contiguous. Thus, '=B2+B4+C7+F19' adds the values from all four cells and places the total in whatever cell you have entered the formula.

To calculate the average of the values in cells B2 through B5, you would add to get the total, then divide the total by the number of values added together: '= (B2+B3+B4+B5)/4' adds the values in the four cells, then divides the total by 4 to calculate the average number of items in each category. You can get really fancy with formulas: '= (F2+F22)/((E2+E5)-(F2*F3))' uses addition (+), subtraction (-), multiplication (*), and division (/). The parentheses indicate the order in which the operations are to be performed: the calculations start from the innermost parentheses and work their way out.



Motherboards	22
Processors	38
Sound Cards	3
Mice	55
Keyboards	55

A typical set of entries to total